

CHRISTMAS PACKAGE

Daniel Hughes Constituent, 29th Senatorial District

December 22, 2025

The Honorable [Office Address] Harrisburg, PA 17120

Subject: A Holiday Reflection on the Commonwealth's First Principles

Dear Senator [Leader's Last Name],

As the legislative session pauses and we enter the quiet reflection of the Christmas season, I hope you will accept this brief paper not as another policy document, but as a contribution to that spirit of reflection. This time of year invites us to look back at our foundations—as families, as a community, and as a Commonwealth—and to consider the legacy we wish to carry into the New Year.

In that spirit, I was recently re-reading our Commonwealth's history, and it struck me that the principles at the heart of our most pressing policy debates are not new. They are, in fact, foundational.

William Penn conceived of this state as a "Holy Experiment," a "haven for religious and political tolerance." We often remember this as a moral position, but it was also a profound economic strategy. That radical policy of liberty and pluralism is what attracted the diverse mix of thinkers, artisans, and farmers who made Pennsylvania the engine of the new world. It was the policy of tolerance that created the environment for a Franklin to innovate, for foundries to rise, and for a nation to be built from the ingenuity that flourished here.

Penn's great insight was that the proper role of government is not to coerce the conscience or the character of its citizens, but to secure the space for them to build their own lives. He trusted in the virtue of a self-governing people. The question for us today, as stewards of his legacy, is simple: Do we?

Because the current policy of cannabis prohibition is, at its core, an act of coercion. It is the paternalistic state telling a free people what they can and cannot choose for themselves. In doing so, it has created the very chaos and danger it claims to prevent. It has fostered a contaminated, illicit market that harms our children, and it has erected

lifelong barriers to employment that deny our own citizens the chance to practice the virtues of work and redemption. William Penn, who envisioned a haven, would be appalled to see a system that creates such peril and denies so many a second chance.

The framework I have had the honor of presenting to you this past year—an open market with no crony-creating license caps, a low tax that allows legal businesses to compete, and automatic expungement to restore our workforce—is not a radical social experiment. It is a return to first principles. It is the modern application of William Penn's Holy Experiment.

This is a vote to trust our farmers, our entrepreneurs, and our citizens to be self-reliant and prudent. It is a vote to reclaim our legacy as the Keystone State, not of government control, but of liberty and permissionless innovation.

As you and your family celebrate the birth of a child who brought a message of hope, redemption, and a second chance to the world, my hope is that this reflection on our Commonwealth's own founding promise of tolerance and liberty might prove useful.

The New Year will bring with it the opportunity to reaffirm that promise.

Wishing you and yours a Merry Christmas and a prosperous New Year.

Respectfully,
Daniel Hughes